Screen Readers

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What is it for?

Screen readers are pieces of software that announce content audibly. This allows a computer to read text, images, icons, and much more. Screen readers are used if someone does not have enough vision to be able to view content from a screen.

They're especially important for people with visual impairments, learning difficulties or cognitive disabilities, non-native speakers, and people who prefer to listen to content instead of reading it visually.

How to support it

Most devices come with a screen reader installed as standard: VoiceOver on Mac and iPhone, Narrator on Windows, and TalkBack on most Android devices.

- Decorative images and icons aren't read out
- All images are understandable using the alt text
- The order of the page makes sense
- Everything on the page is fully functional using a screen reader

Useful Links

An Introduction to Screen Readers

RNIB: Screen reading software